

DCM — Decision Control Module

Canonical Definition

Decision Control defines the structure by which decisions are classified, limited, and governed according to predefined authority levels, thresholds, and conditions.

A system is not controlled if decisions are made without defined limits and structure.

Purpose

This module ensures that:

- decisions are made within defined boundaries
 - authority operates within controlled limits
 - critical decisions are escalated correctly
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Core Principle

Uncontrolled decisions create uncontrolled systems.

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

The system MUST define:

1. Decision Levels

At minimum:

- Operational (routine decisions)
 - Critical (high-impact decisions)
 - Crisis (system-level decisions)
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2. Authority Scope

Each level MUST define:

- who can decide
 - what can be decided
 - under what conditions
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3. Decision Limits

The system MUST define:

- thresholds (financial, operational, risk)
 - maximum allowed impact per level
 - conditions requiring escalation
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4. Approval Conditions

The system MUST define:

- when additional approval is required
 - multi-actor decision conditions (if applicable)
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Mandatory Conditions

- all decisions MUST fall within defined levels
 - decisions MUST not exceed defined limits
 - escalation MUST be triggered when thresholds are exceeded
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Prohibited Conditions

- decisions outside defined levels
 - undefined authority scope
 - decisions exceeding limits without escalation
 - uncontrolled high-impact decisions
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Output

The system produces:

Structured Decision Flow

Controlled Decision Boundaries

System Condition

- **Valid** → all decisions operate within defined structure
 - **Invalid** → any decision outside control framework
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Use Case 1 — Financial Approval

Without module:

- spending decisions exceed limits
- no escalation

With module:

- thresholds defined
- escalation triggered

Result:

- controlled financial risk
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Use Case 2 — AI Decision Execution

Without module:

- AI executes high-impact decisions without limits
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With module:

- decision thresholds enforced
- escalation triggered

Result:

- controlled AI behavior
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Closing Insight

If decisions have no limits, the system has no control.

Related Documents

[→ CGRM Standard](#)

[→ CGRM Modules Overview](#)

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Canonical Source

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